

The PrimeTech Foundation Story

By Wandili Ronald, Founder and CEO of PrimeTech Foundation

Introduction

In Kenya, a nation brimming with youthful energy and ambition, the disconnect between academic education and job market requirements has become increasingly evident. While schools continue to produce graduates annually, many find themselves ill-equipped for the evolving demands of the global workforce. This realization sparked the inception of the PrimeTech Foundation—a mission-driven organization committed to integrating technology into education and empowering marginalized communities.

The Challenge: Education vs. Employment

Kenya's youth unemployment rate remains a pressing concern. According to the World Bank, as of 2023, the overall unemployment rate stood at 5.6%, with youth unemployment at 8.4% . However, these figures often mask the underemployment and informal sector dominance, where many young people engage in low-paying, unstable jobs without social security benefits .[World Bank](#)[The Star](#)[The Star](#)

Moreover, the formal sector's capacity to absorb new entrants is limited. In 2022, only 14% of the 816,000 jobs created were in the formal sector, leaving the majority in informal employment. This scenario underscores the urgent need to align educational outcomes with market realities. [ChegzMad Consultancy](#)[+1 The Star](#)[+1 The Star](#)

The Digital Divide:- Despite advancements in technology, a significant portion of Kenya's population remains offline. As of January 2023, internet penetration stood at 32.7%, with 17.86 million users, indicating that over 36 million Kenyans were not using the internet. This digital divide disproportionately affects rural and marginalized communities, limiting access to information, opportunities, and digital literacy.[Yazi](#)[+1 DataReportal – Global Digital Insights](#)[+1 DataReportal – Global Digital Insights](#)

Furthermore, only 40% of Kenya's population has access to reliable electricity, with many rural areas lacking the infrastructure necessary for digital learning. This lack of access hampers efforts to integrate technology into education and skill development. [Wikipedia](#)

The PrimeTech Foundation's Mission

In response to these challenges, the PrimeTech Foundation was established with a clear mission: to bridge the gap between education and employment by integrating technology into learning and equipping the next generation with relevant skills. Our core areas of intervention include:

1. **Curriculum Integration:** Collaborating with educational institutions to introduce tech-based learning modules aligned with real-world job requirements.

2. **Community Empowerment:** Offering workshops, boot camps, and training sessions targeted at marginalized groups, especially youth and women in underdeveloped areas.
3. **AI and Future Skills Awareness:** Demystifying artificial intelligence and emerging technologies, preparing learners for the evolving job market.

Collaborations with Educational Institutions

Recognizing the pivotal role of educators, the PrimeTech Foundation partners with schools and universities to establish tech clubs and innovation hubs. These platforms provide students with hands-on experience in coding, robotics, and digital design, fostering creativity and problem-solving skills.

Teacher training programs are also integral to our approach, ensuring that educators are equipped to deliver tech-integrated curricula effectively. By empowering teachers, we amplify our impact across entire classrooms and communities.

Empowering Marginalized Communities

Marginalized communities often face systemic barriers to education and employment. Through targeted outreach programs, the PrimeTech Foundation delivers digital literacy training, coding workshops, and entrepreneurship support to underserved populations.

For instance, our initiatives have enabled young women in rural areas to develop mobile applications addressing local challenges, such as agricultural market access and healthcare information dissemination. These success stories exemplify the transformative potential of technology when made accessible to all.

Addressing the AI Evolution

Artificial Intelligence is reshaping industries and labor markets globally. However, in many Kenyan schools and Africa at large, AI remains an abstract concept. The PrimeTech Foundation seeks to change this narrative by introducing AI literacy programs that cover basic concepts, real-life applications, and ethical considerations.

By fostering an understanding of AI, we prepare learners to navigate and contribute to a future where technology plays an increasingly central role.

Promoting Entrepreneurship and Reducing Government Dependency

Traditional employment avenues, particularly in the public sector, are no longer sufficient to absorb the growing youth population. The PrimeTech Foundation promotes entrepreneurship as a viable alternative, encouraging young people to create their own opportunities.

Programs like the Kenya Youth Employment and Opportunities Project (KYEOP) have demonstrated the potential of entrepreneurship in job creation, with over 155,000 young people

launching businesses and creating 125,000 jobs. By equipping youth with entrepreneurial skills, we aim to foster self-reliance and economic resilience. [World Bank+1The Star+1](#)

Looking Ahead:- The journey of the PrimeTech Foundation is just beginning. As we continue to expand our reach and impact, we remain committed to our vision of a Kenya where every young person, regardless of background, has access to quality, relevant, and empowering education.

We invite educators, policymakers, and stakeholders to join us in this mission. Together, we can harness the power of technology to transform education, empower communities, and build a future where all Kenyans can thrive.